D2 · BUILD SHEET

What we build, in what order, and what it changes

Built on the existing HR platform's recruitment module · 4 months to the seasonal peak · Reusable for the two other customers asking for it

1 What we add to the platform we already have

One new service (ranking and shortlist). Everything else extends parts that already exist.

PART	WHAT WE ADD
Requisitions (jobs)	Must-haves (pass/fail) and 5 ranking criteria with weights, versioned and approved. Recruiter settings: **shortlist size N**, **reserve size**, **approve first or auto-send**, country rules.
Career site & job boards	Notice and consent for WhatsApp/SMS contact. Each application goes straight to the agent for a first reply.
Messaging (WhatsApp/SMS)	Fixed, pre-approved questions with tap-to-answer buttons, in local languages. Falls back to SMS. Invite, reminder and outcome messages.
New: ranking & shortlist service	Scores eligible applicants 0–100 on the 5 criteria, with personal details hidden. Runs daily per job. Moves the cut-off when N changes. Invites the reserve list when someone declines.
Interview scheduling	Open slots shown inside the chat. Booking, reminders and rescheduling.
Candidate record	An audit trail for each applicant that can't be edited (every check, score, decision and message). A no-login page where applicants see their application data and ask why they weren't selected (no scores shown).
Recruiter mobile app	Review and approve a shortlist in one click, change N, add someone with a reason (logged), confirm "not eligible" in Germany, and do the weekly spot-check.

2 Scope for the 4-month launch

In

- Must-have checks, with WhatsApp/SMS questions for anything missing
- Ranking on 5 job criteria; shortlist of top N plus reserve, set by the recruiter
- Interview self-booking in the chat; automatic reserve invites
- Reasons for every "no", plus the applicant data page
- Audit trail view and export; weekly fairness report; on/off switch per country and site

Not now (and why)

- **Scoring CV text with AI.** Hurts phone applicants (the hiring manager's worry) and is hard to explain.
- **Recruiter-editable weights.** Consistency and audit first. Changes go through approval.
- **Video interview analysis** and **open-ended AI chat.** High risk, not needed for speed.
- **Predicting job performance.** Revisit after peak, with real outcome data.

3 Plan: four months, with a check at the end of each

MONTH	WHAT WE BUILD	MUST BE TRUE TO MOVE ON
1	Must-have checks and WhatsApp/SMS questions; audit trail writing; criteria set up with hiring managers.	**Replay of last year's hires: strong hires (including the best hire) pass must-haves and rank inside a normal shortlist. Legal reviews started.**
2	Ranking & shortlist service; recruiter settings and approval; chat booking and reserve invites.	**"Shadow run" on ~2,500 live applications: the agent's top N overlaps 80%+ with recruiters' own picks.**
3	Audit trail view and exports; fairness report; spot-check; load test at 3× peak volume.	**Live for 25%, then 75%, of US and India jobs; Germany with recruiter approval if the works council has agreed, otherwise the reply-and-book fallback. Counsel sign-off (and bias audit where required).**
4	All jobs live before peak; setup templates for the two other customers.	**Spot-check error under 2%. Every group's invite rate at least 80% of the highest group's.**

Team: 1 product manager · 1 designer · 5 engineers (messaging, scheduling, ranking, platform) · 1 data scientist (ranking, fairness, measurement) · part-time privacy/legal partner · the customer's recruiting operations lead.

4 Impact table

Targets are our estimates. We confirm them in the month-2 shadow run before promising them to the customer.

WHAT WE MEASURE	TODAY	TARGET AT PEAK	HOW WE MEASURE IT
Time to first reply	9 days (median)	**Under 5 minutes, 24/7**	Time from application to first message
Time to interview invite (shortlisted)	Not tracked (est. 2+ weeks)	**Under 24 hours (daily ranking)**	Time from application to invite
Applicants who get a decision and a reason	Many never hear back	**100%**	Share of applications with an outcome message
Recruiter time on first-stage screening	~33,000 hours a year to read every application (400k × 5 min)	**~3,000 hours a year**	Time in the recruiter app (shortlist approvals, Germany confirmations, spot-checks, appeals)
Shortlist quality	Unknown	**80%+ overlap with recruiters' picks; interview-to-offer rate at least as good as today**	Shadow run; then interview outcomes by rank
Good applicants wrongly turned away	Unknown	**Under 2%**	Weekly recruiter spot-check of "not eligible" and just-below-cut-off applicants
Fairness between groups	Not measured	**Every group's invite rate at least 80% of the highest; auto-pause if not**	Weekly report, using optional self-declared data the agent never sees
Interview slots filled	Gaps from no-shows and ghosting	**95%+ of slots booked**	Bookings ÷ slots; reserve invites used
Audit requests	Manual reconstruction, days	**Any applicant's trail in under 1 minute**	Export time from the audit view

5 Risks, and what we do about them

RISK	WHAT WE DO
Good people fall just below the cut-off	Reserve list, weekly spot-check below the line, and a "ask why" reply (a plain reason, no scores).
Recruiters set N too low or too high	Suggested N based on openings and past no-show rate. The app warns if slots and N don't match.
Ranking drifts or favours one group	Weekly fairness report, automatic pause per country or site, versioned criteria, and an independent bias audit where required.
German approvals (works council, GDPR review) take longer than 4 months	Recruiter approval covers the GDPR point but may not replace works council consent. Fallback: in Germany the agent only sends first replies, asks questions and books interviews; recruiters shortlist as they do today. US and India launch on time either way.
WhatsApp unavailable or not used	Automatic switch to SMS with the same reply codes.

Estimate behind the hours row: reading 400,000 applications at ~5 minutes each is ~33,000 hours. After launch, recruiters spend about a minute per shortlist approval, plus Germany confirmations, spot-checks and appeals.